started in chapter 12 in this chapter, but the process is identical if you're building an API application using web API controllers.

.NET 7 significantly simplified the number of steps you need to get started with JWT authentication by adding some conventions, which we'll discuss shortly. To add JWT to an existing API application, first install the Microsoft.AspNetCore.Authentication.JwtBearer NuGet package using the .NET CLI

```
dotnet add package Microsoft.AspNetCore.Authentication.JwtBearer
```

or by adding the `<PackageReference>` to your project directly:

```
<PackageReference Include="Microsoft.AspNetCore.Authentication.JwtBearer"
    Version="7.0.0" />
```

Next, add the required services to configure JWT authentication for your application, as shown in listing 25.1. As you may remember, the authentication and authorization middleware are automatically added to your middleware pipeline by `WebApplication`, but if you want to control the position of the middleware, you can override the location, as I do here.

Listing 25.1 Adding JWT bearer authentication to a minimal API application

```
WebApplicationBuilder builder = WebApplication.CreateBuilder(args);

builder.Services.AddAuthentication()          ❶
    .AddJwtBearer();                          ❷
builder.Services.AddAuthorization();          ❸

builder.Services.AddScoped<RecipeService>();

WebApplication app = builder.Build();

app.UseAuthentication();                      ❹
```